Speak out 3RD EDITION

B2+
PROGRESS TEST 4 | Version A

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Put the words in brackets in the correct order to complete the sentences.

1 I _____ (into / Juan / last / bumped / Friday) when I was at the shopping centre.
2 I don't know why, but she _____ (at / in / funny / me / a / looked / way).
3 _____ (time / From / to / visit / time, / we) my grandparents at their cottage in the country.
4 I must say that they _____ (happy / didn't / particularly / look) to see us.
5 To _____ (pleasure / found / I / out / my) that I had won first prize in the short story competition.
6 We hadn't been horse riding before. _____ (that, / of / booked / we / Because) a lesson.
7 _____ (how / as / love / you / Seeing) sushi, I've bought some for dinner.
8 _____ (result / of / As / achieving / a) such a good grade for the course, she had the fees refunded.
9 _____ (poor / Disappointed / the / by / turnout) at last year's festival, they're not going to repeat it.
10 _____ (fact / that / In / the / view / of) neither of us can drive, we'll need to take the coach.

/10

2 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 **However** / **While** there are plenty of green spaces in the city, there are few play areas for children.
2 **Although** / **At the same time** I sent her a message yesterday morning, I still haven't had a reply.
3 **Admittedly** / **Even though**, they've made some great songs, but this one is awful.
4 Ridiculous **as** / **that** it may sound, I promise you it's a true story.
5 Intelligent **that** / **though** he might be, he clearly lacks empathy.
6 There's no way I'll **be working** / **have worked** here in five years' time. I want to leave by the end of this year.
7 Do you think the shop will **close** / **have closed** yet? I wanted to buy some groceries.
8 By the time she's fifty, she'll **have made** / **have been made** CEO of the company.
9 He's going to be exhausted when he arrives because he'll **have been driven** / **have been driving** all night.
10 The shower might **have been fixing** / **have been fixed** by this weekend, but there's no guarantee.

/10

VOCABULARY

3 Choose the correct options (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 Her latest poem ___ a real sense of sadness.
a conveys **b** defines **c** specifies
2 Let's ___ what we've talked about today before finishing the class.
a spell out **b** signify **c** sum up
3 When the government didn't meet their demands, the union ___ to strike action.
a remained **b** reverted **c** transformed
4 The band ___ onto the music scene in the 1970s with a number one hit.
a declined **b** evolved **c** exploded
5 The arrival of social media was a ___ for change in the country.
a catalyst **b** shift **c** surge

/5

4 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 It's better to avoid food with too **much cholesterol** / **many nutrients** because it can be bad for your heart.
2 The strawberries were really expensive because they were **in season** / **out of season**.
3 It's OK to eat **junk** / **organic** food every once in a while, but it's better not to eat it all the time.
4 Listening to that song **reminded** / **took** me back to my university days.
5 The show's producers were trying to **recreate** / **reminisce** the feeling of a long-lost era.

/5

5 Complete the sentences with the words in the box. There are three words you do not need.

conveyor	**curfew**	**greed**	**harmony**	**idealism**
paranoia	**scan**	**teleport**		

1 You're not being followed. You're experiencing _____.
2 My dream is for everyone in the world to live in peace and _____.
3 Due to the _____, they were unable to leave their houses after dark.
4 You need to put your luggage on the _____ and it will be transported to the aeroplane.
5 I wish I could _____ to work every day so I didn't have to make the same boring journey.

/5

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6 Complete the sentences with words and phrases for science and technology.

1 The doctor attached a device so she could **m** _ _ _ _ _ **r** my heart.
2 This machine is used to **g** _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** electricity from the power of the waves.
3 If you press this button, it will **a** _ _ _ _ _ _ **e** the fire alarm.
4 I've got a new **h** _ _ _ **-** _ _ _ **d** video console, which is small enough to fit in my bag.
5 Do you think this type of plastic is **r** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **e**? I don't want to just throw it away.

/5

HOW TO …

7 Choose the correct options (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 We went to a ___ restaurant for my birthday. It was expensive, but it was worth it for the experience.
a classy **b** dull **c** shabby
2 After I left this morning, I realised I wasn't wearing ___ socks. They were different colours.
a fancy **b** matching **c** vintage
3 ___ a million times, I don't like watching any sports.
a It takes **b** They're about **c** I've told you
4 My feet are ___ me. I need to sit down for a while.
a killing **b** dying **c** starving
5 You'll literally be ___ once you've seen their new house. It's amazing!
a nothing better **b** green with envy
c a needle in a haystack
6 If you ___ a little money every month, you'll soon save enough for a new pair of trainers.
a blow **b** put aside **c** splash out
7 I didn't buy the headphones because they were ___. I saw them for half that price in another shop.
a economical **b** discounted **c** overpriced
8 ___ say you'll regret it if you leave your job now.
a I dare **b** Frankly **c** It seems
9 I guess that's ___ of looking at it, but I'm not sure I agree with you.
a one side **b** one way **c** the other hand
10 It's been ___ to you, but I must go now.
a great talking **b** nice looking **c** good saying

/10

Total: /50

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Part B • Listening and Reading

LISTENING

1 [Audio PT4.01] Listen to a speaker, Jasmine Patterson, talking about trends in education. Complete the sentences with a number, word or short phrase.

1 People with experience in the education _____ should be aware of changes in educational practice.
2 Some people might find the expression 'grammar school' a little _____.
3 The first grammar schools to be paid for by the government were established in the _____.
4 Some people were against the grammar school system because they thought it was _____.
5 The number of grammar schools has been in _____ for a number of decades.
6 It has been proven that SEL can help students increase their _____ at school.
7 Apart from pupils' social development, SEL is also concerned with their _____ development.
8 Some critics of SEL think it might cause young people to experience _____.
9 PBL is described as being a _____ way of teaching where students work on real-world problems.
10 In PBL, the way students work together and how good their projects are form the basis of _____.

/10

2 [Audio PT4.02] Listen to a radio discussion about innovations in the year 2050. Match each statement with one of the innovations: human-like robots (HR), smart cities (SC) or a space elevator (SE). The innovations may be used more than once.

1 A previously used idea will have been modified to improve the urban environment. ___
2 Something resembling this innovation has appeared in the media recently. ___
3 This innovation will result in financial savings in the future. ___
4 This concept is not likely to have been perfected by 2050. ___
5 We will be interacting with this innovation in our daily lives by 2050. ___

/5

3 [Audio PT4.02] Listen again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Felicity agrees with the presenter's view about something he saw on television. **T** / **F**
2 Felicity doubts that human-like robots will be able to read human facial expressions. **T** / **F**
3 Felicity thinks smart cities designed in consultation with local residents will already have been created by 2050. **T** / **F**
4 The improved social conditions in smart cities will result in greater financial success. **T** / **F**
5 Scientists have made no progress in overcoming issues related to the construction of the space elevator. **T** / **F**

/5

READING

4 Read four extracts in which people talk about changing eating habits. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 Phyllis explains that previous generations' attitudes to eating were a result of limited availability of certain types of food. **T** / **F**
2 Phyllis points out that the only consequence of modern eating habits is lower quality diets. **T** / **F**
3 Alberto suggests that young people are too lazy to spend their time cooking meals. **T** / **F**
4 Alberto believes the fast-food sector has been responsible for more varied dining experiences. **T** / **F**
5 Lois doubts that attitudes to eating led to a higher quality of life in certain countries. **T** / **F**
6 Brett explains that some people went back to old cooking techniques because they thought microwave ovens were unsafe. **T** / **F**
7 Brett points out that some well-known chefs are doubtful about the potential of microwave ovens. **T** / **F**

/7

A Phyllis

If I think back to the eating habits of my grandparents' generation, things have changed a great deal. Lacking access to the wide range of ingredients which we have today, they were more aware of the need to be frugal in their eating habits. Their tendency to eat each meal at the same time every day would have avoided the need to be constantly snacking as we do today. For the younger generation, it's easy to forget that binge eating is a relatively modern concept. Nowadays, we consume tea and coffee whenever we feel like it and, due to the explosion in remote working, more than half of us are grabbing snacks at random times throughout the day. Not only has this contributed to poorer diets, but this tendency has also led to more food waste. Many of our half-eaten dishes and snacks end up in the bin, and it's estimated that globally nearly 930 million tonnes of food waste are generated every year. This is thought to be the equivalent of 8–10 percent of annual carbon emissions.

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B Alberto
The restaurant sector has seen some significant changes in the past few decades. Eating out has become more popular in many countries, especially among the younger generation. Their hectic schedules don't permit them to spend hours slaving over a hot stove, which has undoubtedly led to a decline in the ability to cook. Nevertheless, they are much more knowledgeable about eating out, thanks to the widespread use of social media for selecting from a range of eating establishments. The desire for a more efficient experience has been the catalyst for the explosion in the number of fast-food chains in recent years. Shorter waiting times and greater customer turnover are a win-win for both restaurants and customers. The surge in demand for this type of restaurant has also been driven by economic considerations, particularly amongst young people who have seen wages rise very little. However, while they don't want to spend a fortune on their food, neither do they want to compromise on quality. As a result, some of the most exciting innovations have been in the fast-food sector.

C Lois
In many parts of the world, the pressures of work and home life have meant that attitudes towards eating have changed. Even in countries like Spain and Italy, where the whole family would traditionally sit down to eat together at certain times of the day, people have been switching to a more flexible approach to mealtimes. This recognition of the importance of regular meals, alongside high-quality ingredients, contributed to a higher life expectancy than many other countries. Some people are concerned that the new approach of eating when you feel like it – also known as 'grazing' – has been responsible for the surge in obesity and poor nutrition in recent years. Nevertheless, evidence has emerged suggesting that it may not be as simple as that. While afternoon grazing may well lead to more negative health outcomes, it seems that grazing in the morning has the opposite effect. In other words, we should keep an open mind regarding the consequences of changes in people's eating habits.

D Brett
Microwave ovens were the food fad of the 1980s, which revolutionised the preparation of meals at home. Perfect for the aspirational consumer who didn't want to waste time in the kitchen, they reduced cooking times by up to 75 percent. However, concerns about food safety and the quality of the food, once cooked, soon emerged. Some people wondered whether it was a good idea to blast your food with radiation, while others complained about the microwave's tendency to turn most food types into something resembling rubber. As a result, people reverted to more traditional ways of cooking and the surge of interest in home cooking led to more people learning how to cook better than ever before. Nevertheless, rising energy bills have led many people to revisit the microwave in recent years. This is because the reduced cooking time obviously leads to significant savings on electricity. Not only that, but the microwave has also benefitted from expressions of support from well-known chefs. Because of this, this humble machine is now being used more creatively and with better results than ever before.

5 Read the extracts again. For questions 1–4, choose the correct speaker (A, B, C or D).

Which speaker …

1 shares the same opinion as Phyllis that, in the past, people were more conscious of the need to keep a regular routine? ___
2 takes the opposite view to Alberto on whether culinary skills have improved on the whole? ___
3 has a different opinion from Lois about the fact that modern eating habits may have led to improved nutritional standards? ___
4 has a similar view to Brett regarding the way financial concerns have caused consumers to experiment more with more economical ways of eating? ___

/8

6 Read an extract from a story. Tick the topics (1–5) which are mentioned.

1 The narrator's favourite type of weather. ___
2 The reason why Lulu is no longer with the narrator. ___
3 The narrator's admiration for Lulu's attitude. ___
4 The narrator's frustration at the behaviour of consumers. ___
5 The narrator's intention to keep doing his job. ___

/5

Making my way home at the end of another shift, the streets are silent except for the inoffensive hum emitted by the delivery bots going about their business. You'd be forgiven for thinking it's a winter's day, the sun struggling to cut through the thick grey sky. In reality, it's the middle of July and we're in the midst of yet another Bad Air Day. The pollution count is through the roof and no one would dare step outside unless they had a death wish. Fortunately, my considerate employers have equipped me with a full face mask, so I should live to work another shift. As I near my apartment, I pull the mask off and breath in the filthy air, instantly breaking into a nasty hacking cough. How did we allow ourselves to get into this situation?

Entering the cramped apartment, I leave the face mask by the door and go into the lounge. As I sink down into the sofa, I glimpse Lulu looking back at me from her digital frame. Even though she's smiling, there's a slight look of concern on her face. It's as if she's worried about the state of my life, or she can't understand why I took a job as a Jabber. Maybe if she were still here, I wouldn't be doing it. But I've got to pay the bills somehow and there weren't many other opportunities apart from Omnium. Sure, Jabbers aren't exactly popular with folk around here, but someone has to keep things in order. If it weren't for us, who knows what would have happened by now?

Lulu was always the optimistic one in our relationship, even when things started to get worse. I'd make fun of her idealism, but deep down I had nothing but respect for her outlook on life. She could always see the good in others, even when I couldn't.

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I remember one time some scruffy little boys tried to steal her shopping on the intercity shuttle. The Jabbers were onto them immediately, but she refused to press charges. She insisted that the Jabbers let them go because the boys were starving and didn't know any better. If it had been up to me, they'd have been punished for their greed with a week in the banger. Yet not only had Lulu asked for them to be released, but she gave them her shopping as well. Talk about an angel!

What I could never accept was the way we let things spiral out of control. The environment was trashed, and crime and poverty had exploded. Even if I wanted to, how could I have any compassion for my fellow humans? It was as though we lost all common sense as soon as we got our hands on those virtual PAs. We simply handed over access to our most personal data, as well as our bank accounts, to Omnium. We'd fought for years to restrict state surveillance, but all of a sudden we were allowing Omnium to carry it out in our homes. Their cute little digiboxes with the soothing voice monitored and recorded our every word and gesture. Then all the information they'd gathered was used to sell us more Omnium junk. They turned us into consumer-slaves and we paid them for the privilege.

I'm not surprised things have got so bad, just amazed we've lasted this long. Omnium goods continue to roll off the conveyor belts, straight into the storage compartments of their delivery bots. They stream out of the factories day and night, making sure that supply never falls behind demand. Yet no one stops to consider the true cost of all this consumerism: unimaginable levels of air pollution, the indefensible contamination of our water supply, and the disappearance of any hope for the future. All I can do as a Jabber is to make sure no one interferes with those delivery bots so their little wheels keep turning until the inevitable day when everything grinds to a halt.

7 Read the extract again. Choose the correct answer (A, B, C or D).

1 What does the narrator suggest in the first paragraph?
- **A** The noise of the delivery bots is particularly annoying.
- **B** The weather is warmer than you would expect for July.
- **C** The pollution poses a serious threat to people's health.
- **D** The sun is weak because it is a winter's day.

2 How does the narrator feel about being a Jabber?
- **A** Pleased because it is what Lulu would have wanted.
- **B** Worried about whether it opens up further career opportunities.
- **C** Concerned about the lack of popularity of people in his role.
- **D** Resigned to the fact that he has few professional choices.

3 What does the narrator say about Lulu in the third paragraph?
- **A** She showed more empathy towards others than he did.
- **B** She had been optimistic until the situation deteriorated.
- **C** He found it hard to respect her attitude towards life.
- **D** He can't understand why she helped the scruffy boys.

4 What regret is implied by the narrator in the fourth paragraph?
- **A** Not showing more compassion to his fellow humans.
- **B** Not preventing Omnium from gathering information in people's homes.
- **C** Relying too much on common sense to fight back against Omnium.
- **D** Spending so much of his own money on junk products from Omnium.

5 How does the writer feel about the situation he is in?
- **A** He wants to change people's attitudes to Omnium.
- **B** He hopes to stop the delivery bots from doing their job.
- **C** He presumes nothing can be done to change the world.
- **D** He thinks that the work done by Omnium is amazing.

/10

Total: /50

Part C • Speaking and Writing

SPEAKING

1 Describe and compare the pictures showing people using technology in the workplace. How important to the jobs is the technology being used in these workplaces?





/15

2 Answer your partner's question.

/5

3 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures. Ask: To what extent do trends affect the clothes the people are wearing?

WRITING

4 Match 1–5 with a–e to complete the sentences from blog posts and opinion essays.

1 What drives me nuts ___
2 The ice caps are at risk of ___
3 It is sometimes necessary to ___
4 How am I supposed to ___
5 To me, it's just people ___

a being lazy and not thinking about the environment.
b know why there aren't any cycle lanes?
c explain the dangers to people in simple language.
d is people that don't recycle their waste.
e melting forever if we do not act soon.

/5

5 Read the essay question below and write your response.

'The rich are getting richer and the poor are getting poorer.'

To what extent do you agree with this opinion?

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /40